coal fires. In 1898 he founded the Coal Smoke Abatement Society (CSAS) to lobby politicians for clean air. The CSAS was instrumental in the introduction of the UK's Public Health (Smoke Abatement) Act in 1926 and the Clean Air Act in 1956.

See also: Pollution

THEODORE ROOSEVELT

1858–1919

To deal with severe childhood asthma, Roosevelt became an active sportsman and outdoorsman, developing a lifelong passion for nature. When, in 1900, he stood as William McKinley's running mate in the US presidential election, he did so on a ticket of peace, prosperity, and conservation. Roosevelt became the 26th President when McKinley was assassinated in 1901, and went on to establish the US Forest Service, five new national parks, 51 bird reserves, and 150 national forests.

See also: Deforestation

JÓSEF PACZOSKI

1864–1942

Paczoski was a Polish ecologist, born in what is now Ukraine. He studied botany at the University of Kiev and went on to pioneer phytosociology, the study of natural plant communities, first using the term in 1896. In the 1920s Paczoski established the world's first institute of phytosociology, at the University of Poznan, where he was professor of plant systematics. An accomplished botanist, he published works on central European flora, including that of the Białowieza Forest, which he managed as a national park.

See also: Organisms and their environment